UNIT 5

Strong verbs IV–VII

This unit completes the principal strong-verb classes with selected present and preterite indicative systems. Four further verbs from Classes I–III provide the forms needed for the complete fifth Cook exercise.

In the tables, **1**, **2** and **3** mean first, second and third person; **sg.** and **pl.** mean singular and plural. **1–3 pl.** gives the same form for all three plural persons. Dual subjects also take plural verbs. Each verb's paired finite tables cover all six present and all six preterite indicative cells. Preserve the printed quantities and the distinction between e and ę.

1. Principal parts and endings

Strong verbs change their stem vowel in the preterite; the weak verbs learned earlier add a dental element. Four principal parts identify the strong stem series. The infinitive names the verb, the singular preterite gives the first/third singular stem, the plural preterite gives the plural stem, and the participle completes the cited series.

Person and number	Present	Preterite
1 sg.	-e, with the special contracted and -ie forms below	singular preterite stem; no added ending
2 sg.	-st or -est, with the listed stem changes	plural preterite stem + -e
3 sg.	-ð or -eð, with the listed stem changes	singular preterite stem; no added ending
1–3 pl.	-að, with the listed contracted and -iað forms	plural preterite stem + -on

The **second singular preterite uses the plural stem**. Thus beran has bær for the first and third singular, but bǣre beside plural bǣron. In other verbs the singular and plural stem vowels coincide; their different endings still identify the cells.

The infinitive and participle columns are **supplied citations** throughout this unit. Consult them in the principal-part exercises. They do not require independent nonfinite recall or the use of infinitive, participial, perfect or

passive constructions. A participle in a four-part entry is not another finite preterite.

The second and third singular present often have a changed vowel and a reduced ending. Short e may appear as i; short a gives æ, short ea gives short ie, long ēa gives long īe, ā gives ǣ, and ō gives ē in the stated paradigms. These changes are lexical patterns, not an instruction to alter every similar-looking vowel. Dental combinations give forms such as -tst and -tt, and doubled stem consonants simplify before consonantal endings. The tables and notes give the resulting forms together.

Gesēon, gescieppan and geswīcan are learned as separate verbs. Their meanings and forms are stated explicitly. The prefix is not an instruction to create further verbs or to assign a fixed difference in meaning to every prefixed pair. The checked headword **gesēon** follows Cook's dictionary ge-sēon, with the dictionary hyphen omitted; the preterite geseah keeps its printed spelling.

2. Class IV

The ordinary Class IV series is **e : æ : ǣ : o**. Beran shows it directly: the singular past has short æ, while the plural-based past has long ǣ. The fourth vowel belongs to the supplied participle.

Infinitive[1]	Meaning	Preterite sg.	Preterite pl.	Participle[1]
beran	carry	bær	bǣron	boren
niman	take	nōm	nōmon	numen
cuman	come	cōm	cōmon	cumen

[1] Infinitive and participle entries are supplied citations. The middle columns identify the finite preterite stems; the complete person assignments follow.

Present indicative.

Person and number	beran	niman	cuman
1 sg.	bere	nime	cume
2 sg.	birst	nimst	cymst
3 sg.	birð	nimð	cymð
1–3 pl.	berað	nimað	cumað

Preterite indicative.

Person and number	beran	niman	cuman
1 sg.	bær	nōm	cōm
2 sg.	bǣre	nōme	cōme
3 sg.	bær	nōm	cōm
1–3 pl.	bǣron	nōmon	cōmon

Learn **niman** and **cuman** separately within this class. This course selects Cook's nōm, nōme, nōmon and cōm, cōme, cōmon. Cuman changes u to y in cymst and cymð; its first singular cume and plural cumað retain u. Niman keeps i in its present forms.

Alternatives. Beran also has bierst and bierð. Wright records nam and nāmon beside the selected nōm and nōmon. Cook gives cwōm and cwōmon beside cōm and cōmon, and the participle citation cymen beside cumen. These alternatives are available for comparison; use the selected table when a task expressly requests it.

3. Class V

The ordinary Class V series is **e : æ : ǣ : e**. It differs from Class IV in the participle vowel. Sprecan gives the ordinary series; several other verbs require their own present or preterite changes.

Infinitive[1]	Meaning	Preterite sg.	Preterite pl.	Participle[1]
sprecan	speak	spræc	sprǣcon	sprecen
cweðan	say	cwæð	cwǣdon	cweden
giefan	give	geaf	gēafon	giefen
biddan	ask; request	bæd	bǣdon	beden
licgan	lie; be at rest	læg	lǣgon	legen
sittan	sit	sæt	sǣton	seten
etan	eat	æt	ǣton	eten
sēon	see	seah	sāwon	sewen
gesēon	see	geseah	gesāwon	gesewen

[1] Infinitive and participle entries are supplied citations. The middle columns identify the finite preterite stems; the complete person assignments follow.

Present indicative.

Person and number	**sprecan**	**cweðan**	**giefan**	**biddan**
1 sg.	sprece	cweðe	giefe	bidde
2 sg.	spricst	cwist	giefst	bitst
3 sg.	spricð	cwið	giefð	bitt
1–3 pl.	sprecað	cweðað	giefað	biddað

Person and number	**licgan**	**sittan**	**etan**	**sēon**
1 sg.	licge	sitte	ete	sēo
2 sg.	ligst	sitst	itst	siehst
3 sg.	ligð	sitt	itt	siehð
1–3 pl.	licgað	sittað	etað	sēoð

Person and number	**gesēon**
1 sg.	gesēo
2 sg.	gesiehst
3 sg.	gesiehð
1–3 pl.	gesēoð

Preterite indicative.

Person and number	**sprecan**	**cweðan**	**giefan**	**biddan**
1 sg.	spræc	cwæð	geaf	bæd
2 sg.	sprǣce	cwǣde	gēafe	bǣde
3 sg.	spræc	cwæð	geaf	bæd
1–3 pl.	sprǣcon	cwǣdon	gēafon	bǣdon

Person and number	**licgan**	**sittan**	**etan**	**sēon**
1 sg.	læg	sæt	ǣt	seah
2 sg.	lǣge	sǣte	ǣte	sāwe
3 sg.	læg	sæt	ǣt	seah
1–3 pl.	lǣgon	sǣton	ǣton	sāwon

Person and number	gesēon
1 sg.	geseah
2 sg.	gesāwe
3 sg.	geseah
1–3 pl.	gesāwon

Cweðan has cwist and cwið in the selected second and third singular present. Its past singular cwæð retains ð, while cwǣde and cwǣdon have d; the supplied participle cweden also has d. Keep this consonant change with these stem positions.

Giefan has the palatal series giefan, geaf, gēafon, giefen. In particular, geaf has short ea, but gēafe and gēafon have long ēa. The present forms retain the selected ie spelling.

Biddan, licgan and sittan have doubled consonants in the present first singular and plural, but a single stem consonant before the second/third singular endings. The resulting forms are bitst/bitt, ligst/ligð and sitst/sitt. Their strong pasts use bæd/bǣdon, læg/lǣgon and sæt/sǣton. These are often called **j-presents**: the label explains a present-stem pattern, not a weak preterite.

Etan has itst and itt in the present singular. The selected preterite æt has long æ, as do æte and æton. Its singular past therefore differs from the ordinary short-æ Class V pattern.

Sēon and **gesēon** have contracted presents. Their first singular ends in -o and their plural in -oð. The second and third singular have **short ie**: siehst/siehð and gesiehst/gesiehð. Their plural-based past stems have āw: sāwe/sāwon and gesāwe/gesāwon. Preserve the difference between these forms and the singular seah/geseah.

Alternatives. Third-singular bit, sit and it occur beside selected bitt, sitt and itt. Cook gives līst and līð beside ligst and ligð, and short æt beside selected æt; Wright also gives lāgon beside lǣgon. For sēon, Cook gives the participle segen beside sewen, and Wright records sǣgon and sawen beside sāwon and sewen. The corresponding prefixed citation alternative is gesegen beside gesewen. These spellings do not replace the selected tables or require extra nonfinite recall.

4. Class VI

The ordinary Class VI series is **a : ō : ō : a**. Faran shows it directly. The singular and plural past stems share long ō, and the second singular adds -e to that stem. Present mutation and the special present stems must still be learned separately.

Infinitive[1]	Meaning	Preterite sg.	Preterite pl.	Participle[1]
faran	go; travel	fōr	fōron	faren
slēan	strike; smite	slōg	slōgon	slægen
standan	stand	stōd	stōdon	standen
hębban	raise; lift	hōf	hōfon	hafen
scieppan	create; shape	scēop	scēopon	sceapen
gescieppan	create	gescēop	gescēopon	gesceapen
swęrian	swear	swōr	swōron	sworen

[1] Infinitive and participle entries are supplied citations. The middle columns identify the finite preterite stems; the complete person assignments follow.

Present indicative.

Person and number	faran	slēan	standan	hębban
1 sg.	fare	slēa	stande	hębbe
2 sg.	færst	sliehst	stęntst	hęfst
3 sg.	færð	sliehð	stęnt	hęfð
1–3 pl.	farað	slēað	standað	hębbað

Person and number	scieppan	gescieppan	swęrian
1 sg.	scieppe	gescieppe	swęrie
2 sg.	sciepst	gesciepst	swęrest
3 sg.	sciepð	gesciepð	swęreð
1–3 pl.	scieppað	gescieppað	swęriað

Preterite indicative.

Person and number	faran	slēan	standan	hębban
1 sg.	fōr	slōg	stōd	hōf
2 sg.	fōre	slōge	stōde	hōfe
3 sg.	fōr	slōg	stōd	hōf
1–3 pl.	fōron	slōgon	stōdon	hōfon

Person and number	scieppan	gescieppan	swęrian
1 sg.	scēop	gescēop	swōr
2 sg.	scēope	gescēope	swōre
3 sg.	scēop	gescēop	swōr
1–3 pl.	scēopon	gescēopon	swōron

Slēan has a contracted present: slēa, sliehst, sliehð, slēað. The ie in sliehst and sliehð is short. The selected past has g throughout: slōg, slōge, slōgon. The supplied participle is slægen.

Standan keeps n in the present but loses it in the past stōd/stōdon. Its changed present singulars are stęntst and stęnt. This is the ordinary verb of standing; the earlier reading's opposing-winds construction requires its own supplied explanation.

Hębban and **scieppan** have doubled present consonants in hębbe/hębbað and scieppe/scieppað. The selected second and third singulars have f in hęfst/hęfð and single p in sciepst/sciepð. Their strong pasts are hōf/hōfon and scēop/scēopon, with supplied participles hafen and sceapen. Gescieppan follows its separately given prefixed table.

Swęrian has swęrie, swęrest, swęreð, swęriað, retaining full endings in the second and third singular. Its past is nevertheless strong: swōr, swōre, swōron. An infinitive in -ian does not by itself identify a weak verb. Keep the full -est and -eð in this selected present.

Alternatives. Cook gives scōp/scōpon alongside scēop/scēopon. The corresponding prefix-preserving alternatives are gescōp/gescōpon. Cook also gives the participle slegen beside slægen; Wright records slōh beside singular slōg and the participle slagen. The selected cells remain those in the tables.

5. Class VII

Cook groups these verbs as **reduplicating verbs**; they are commonly called Class VII. For present purposes, learn two past-vowel groups, ēo and ē. Within each verb the selected preterite stem is the same in singular and plural. The present and participle usually share their vowel, but the complete entries preserve exceptions such as wēpan/wōpen and fōn/fangen.

Preterites with ēo

Infinitive[1]	Meaning	Preterite sg.	Preterite pl.	Participle[1]
feallan	fall	fēoll	fēollon	feallen
healdan	hold	hēold	hēoldon	healden
weaxan	grow	wēox	wēoxon	weaxen
cnāwan	know	cnēow	cnēowon	cnāwen
hēawan	hew	hēow	hēowon	hēawen
flōwan	flow	flēow	flēowon	flōwen
wēpan	weep	wēop	wēopon	wōpen

[1] Infinitive and participle entries are supplied citations. The middle columns identify the finite preterite stems; the complete person assignments follow.

Present indicative.

Person and number	feallan	healdan	weaxan	cnāwan
1 sg.	fealle	healde	weaxe	cnāwe
2 sg.	fielst	hieltst	wiext	cnǣwst
3 sg.	fielð	hielt	wiext	cnǣwð
1–3 pl.	feallað	healdað	weaxað	cnāwað

Person and number	hēawan	flōwan	wēpan
1 sg.	hēawe	flōwe	wēpe
2 sg.	hīewst	flēwst	wēpst
3 sg.	hīewð	flēwð	wēpð
1–3 pl.	hēawað	flōwað	wēpað

Preterite indicative.

Person and number	feallan	healdan	weaxan	cnāwan
1 sg.	fēoll	hēold	wēox	cnēow
2 sg.	fēolle	hēolde	wēoxe	cnēowe
3 sg.	fēoll	hēold	wēox	cnēow
1–3 pl.	fēollon	hēoldon	wēoxon	cnēowon

Person and number	hēawan	flōwan	wēpan
1 sg.	hēow	flēow	wēop
2 sg.	hēowe	flēowe	wēope
3 sg.	hēow	flēow	wēop
1–3 pl.	hēowon	flēowon	wēopon

In the present second and third singular, **feallan, healdan and weaxan** change short ea to short ie. Healdan also has the dental results hieltst and hielt. Stem-final x combines with either singular ending as xt: **wiext is both second and third singular** of weaxan. Feallan reduces ll before its endings, giving fielst and fielð.

Cnāwan changes ā to æ in cnæwst/cnæwð; hēawan changes long ēa to long īe in hīewst/hīewð; flōwan changes ō to ē in flēwst/flēwð. Wēpan keeps ē in wēpst/wēpð. In the preterite, cnēow/cnēowon and hēow/hēowon retain their printed consonants and quantities; do not transfer a consonant from another verb's past.

Preterites with ē

Infinitive[1]	Meaning	Preterite sg.	Preterite pl.	Participle[1]
lætan	let	lēt	lēton	læten
hātan	call; name	hēt	hēton	hāten
fōn	seize; catch	fēng	fēngon	fangen

[1] Infinitive and participle entries are supplied citations. The middle columns identify the finite preterite stems; the complete person assignments follow.

Present indicative.

Person and number	**lǣtan**	**hātan**	**fōn**
1 sg.	lǣte	hāte	fō
2 sg.	lǣtst	hǣtst	fēhst
3 sg.	lǣtt	hǣtt	fēhð
1–3 pl.	lǣtað	hātað	fōð

Preterite indicative.

Person and number	**lǣtan**	**hātan**	**fōn**
1 sg.	lēt	hēt	fēng
2 sg.	lēte	hēte	fēnge
3 sg.	lēt	hēt	fēng
1–3 pl.	lēton	hēton	fēngon

Lǣtan has lǣtst and lǣtt in the present; **hātan** changes ā to ǣ in hǣtst and hǣtt. Their preterites are lēt/lēton and hēt/hēton. Third-singular lǣt and hǣt are documented alternatives. Wright also records the older preterite hēht; it is not an additional recall requirement here.

Fōn has the contracted present fō, fēhst, fēhð, fōð and the past fēng, fēnge, fēngon. The nasal consonant belongs to the past stem. The participle fangen remains a supplied citation.

The hātan table is active indicative. The special passive form hātte, commands with infinitives, and the reading's construction with an object and a name are separate matters. The naming phrases in §§11–12 remain supplied in full.

6. Four additions to Classes I–III

The following verbs use classes already learned, but their complete lexical systems are new here. Earlier supplied occurrences do not replace learning these tables. Geswīcan and scīnan follow Class I, flēogan Class II, and swimman the nasal pattern of Class III.

Infinitive[1]	Meaning	Preterite sg.	Preterite pl.	Participle[1]
geswīcan	cease	geswāc	geswicon	geswicen
scīnan	shine	scān	scinon	scinen
flēogan	fly	flēag	flugon	flogen
swimman	swim	swamm	swummon	swummen

[1] Infinitive and participle entries are supplied citations. The middle columns identify the finite preterite stems; the complete person assignments follow.

Present indicative.

Person and number	geswīcan	scīnan	flēogan	swimman
1 sg.	geswīce	scīne	flēoge	swimme
2 sg.	geswīcst	scīnst	flīehst	swimst
3 sg.	geswīcð	scīnð	flīehð	swimð
1–3 pl.	geswīcað	scīnað	flēogað	swimmað

Preterite indicative.

Person and number	geswīcan	scīnan	flēogan	swimman
1 sg.	geswāc	scān	flēag	swamm
2 sg.	geswice	scine	fluge	swumme
3 sg.	geswāc	scān	flēag	swamm
1–3 pl.	geswicon	scinon	flugon	swummon

Geswīcan and scīnan have long ī in the present, long ā in the first/third singular past, and short i in the plural-based past. Flēogan has ēo in the first singular and plural present, long īe in flīehst/flīehð, and u in fluge/flugon. Swimman has short a in swamm but u in swumme/swummon; mm reduces before its present consonantal endings.

Alternatives. Cook records flīegst and flīegð beside selected flīehst and flīehð. The dictionary also attests swimman past alternatives swom and swommon. The tables select the a/u series for swimman and the h spellings for flēogan.

7. Ordinary uses

The glosses in the principal-part tables identify the verbs. The constructions below supply the ordinary uses needed in sentences. For other verbs, the practice asks for labelled person, number and tense forms; a gloss alone does not specify which objects or clauses may follow.

Beran, “carry,” and **niman**, “take,” take an accusative person or thing. The subject controls the finite verb. The following eight examples are new teaching material.

Đū birst ðone męte.

You (singular) carry the food.

Hē nimð ðone fisc.

He takes the fish.

With **giefan**, the thing given is accusative and the recipient is dative. English may express the recipient with “to”; Old English expresses the relation here by the case of the recipient itself.

Ic giefe ðǣm męnn ðone męte.

I give the man the food.

Sittan, “sit,” **licgan**, “lie; be at rest,” and **standan**, “stand,” describe the subject’s posture. A locative **on + dative** phrase can state where that subject is. No object is needed for these ordinary posture uses.

Se mann ligð on ðǣm hofe.

The man lies in the dwelling.

Se mann stęnt on ðǣm strande.

The man stands on the shore.

Feallan, “fall,” **weaxan**, “grow,” **flēogan**, “fly,” **scīnan**, “shine,” and **swimman**, “swim,” have ordinary intransitive uses. The growing tree, flying bird, shining star or swimming fish is the subject. A locative on-phrase may state where the swimming occurs.

Đæt trēo fielð.

The tree falls.

Etan, “eat,” takes an accusative food object; it also occurs with the food understood. **Sēon** and **gesēon**, “see,” take an accusative person or thing in the use practised here. **Slēan**, “strike; smite,” and **healdan**, “hold,” likewise take an accusative object. “Strike” does not by itself say that the object is

killed. **Scieppan** and **gescieppan** take the created being or thing as accusative object in the Creation sentences.

Geswīcan, "cease," takes the **genitive** of the work or action from which one ceases. Keep this government when English uses "cease from." An agreeing possessive takes the case, number and gender of the work noun; the personal genitives his and hiera remain the possessor forms already learned.

Wē geswīcað ūres weorces.

We cease from our work.

Cweðan, "say," can introduce direct quotation. The words inside the quotation form their own clause; a first-person pronoun there denotes the quoted speaker. Content clauses introduced by "that" remain separately supplied in the reading.

Se mann cwið: "Ic sēo ðone fugol."

The man says, "I see the bird."

For these ordinary indicative clauses, put **ne before the finite verb** to negate the statement. A past negative still uses the appropriate strong preterite; English "did not" does not add a separate Old English auxiliary here. Subjects in the dual take plural verb forms, while dual possessives still identify two possessors and agree with the possessed noun.

No new productive noun pattern is needed. Continue the complete noun, adjective, article, pronoun and possessive paradigms of Units 1–4. In particular, the learned masculine heofon supplies plural "heavens"; the reading's weak feminine heofone receives separate local help.

8. Form and clause practice

P, F and C are new teaching exercises. **Selected** means the form in this unit's main tables. Consult the printed principal parts where the prompt supplies them; the nonfinite entries are never independent recall targets. In translation tasks, retain each stated person, number, tense and case relation.

Principal parts — P1–P4

P1.
The printed entry gives beran, bær, bǣron, boren. Label the four principal-part positions. Which entries are finite, and which are nonfinite citations?

P2.
Compare geaf and sealde, both meaning gave. Identify the strong form and the weak form; explain the difference in preterite formation.

P3.
For beran, give the preterite indicative forms for I, you (singular), he, and we. Identify the forms using the preterite plural stem.

P4.
The printed entry gives gescieppan, gescēop, gescēopon, gesceapen. Using it, give you (singular) created and we created. Is gesceapen itself a finite preterite?

Finite forms — F1–F24

F1.
Give the selected indicative forms of beran: present 2sg; preterite 1sg and 2sg.

F2.
Give the selected indicative forms of niman: present 3sg; preterite 3sg and 1pl.

F3.
Give the selected indicative forms of cuman: present 1sg, 2sg and 3sg; preterite 3pl.

F4.
Give the selected indicative forms of sprecan: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 2sg.

F5.
Give the selected indicative forms of cweðan: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 3pl.

F6.
Give the selected indicative forms of giefan: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 1sg and 1pl.

F7.
Give the selected indicative forms of biddan: present 1sg and 3sg; preterite 2sg.

F8.
Give the selected indicative forms of licgan: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 1pl.

F9.
Give the selected indicative forms of sittan: present 3sg; preterite 1sg and 2sg.

F10.
Give the selected indicative forms of etan: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 1sg and 2sg.

F11.
Give the selected indicative forms of sēon: present 1sg, 2sg and 3pl.

F12.
Give the selected indicative forms of gesēon: present 3sg; preterite 2sg and 2pl.

F13.
Give the selected indicative forms of faran: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 1pl.

F14.
Give the selected indicative forms of slēan: present 1sg, 2sg and 2pl; preterite 2sg.

F15.
Give the selected indicative forms of standan: present 2sg and 3sg; preterite 3sg.

F16.
Give the selected indicative forms of hębban: present 1sg and 3sg; preterite 1pl.

F17.
Give the selected indicative forms of scieppan and gescieppan: scieppan: present 1sg and 2sg, preterite 3sg; gescieppan: preterite 3pl.

F18.
Give the selected indicative forms of swęrian: present 1sg, 2sg and 3sg; preterite 2sg.

F19.
Give the selected indicative forms of feallan, healdan and weaxan: present 3sg of each; preterite 1pl of weaxan.

F20.
Give the selected indicative forms of cnāwan and wēpan: present 2sg and preterite 2sg of each.

F21.
Give the selected indicative forms of hēawan and flōwan: present 2sg and preterite 2sg of each.

F22.
Give the selected indicative forms of lǣtan, hātan and fōn: present 3sg of each; preterite 2sg of fōn.

F23.
Give the selected indicative forms of geswīcan and scīnan: present 3sg and preterite 2sg of each.

F24.
Give the selected indicative forms of flēogan and swimman: present 3sg and preterite 3pl of each.

Clauses — C1–C8

C1.
Translate: You (singular) carry the food, and I take the fish.

C2.
Translate using giefan: We (two) gave the men our food (belonging to us two).

C3.
Translate: The companions sat in the dwelling, and the man stood on the shore.

C4.
Translate using etan: I did not eat the food; you (singular) ate it.

C5.
Rewrite with hīe as subject and plural objects: Hē geseah ðone fugol and nōm ðone fisc.

C6.
Translate using cweðan to introduce direct speech: The man says, “I see the trees.”

C7.
Translate using geswīcan: You (plural) cease from your work.

C8.
Translate: The tree falls, and the men hold the ship.

9. Cook I.5

Translate all sixteen sentences into Old English. These are Cook's unchanged English prompts from **Exercises in Old English**, Group I, Exercise 5, printed p.3 (one-based PDF p.11). Use the ordinary constructions taught above and the earlier weak-verb and nominal systems. Original item numbers are retained.

I.5.1.
God created the heavens and the earth.

I.5.2.
God made two great lights.

I.5.3.
God made the firmament.

I.5.4.
God created the great whales.

I.5.5.
He made the beasts of the earth.

Supplied phrase for I.5.6: eall ðā ðing — all those things (accusative plural); use the supplied phrase. Here eall is strong neuter accusative plural, ðā is demonstrative accusative plural, and ðing is neuter accusative plural. The whole phrase remains available; neither eall nor the quantifier construction requires independent production.

I.5.6.
He saw all those things.

I.5.7.
He finished his work.

I.5.8.
He blesses the seventh day.

I.5.9.
The man ceases from his work.

I.5.10.
I see the bird in the tree.

I.5.11.
They saw the fish in the water.

I.5.12.
The birds of the air fly.

I.5.13.
The trees grew.

I.5.14.
The stars shone.

I.5.15.
The fish swims.

I.5.16.
The men swam.

10. Connected reading: Food for the companions and the birds

This account is new teaching material. The preterites narrate successive actions. Read the pronouns in context: hīe after the giving clause can naturally refer to the companions, but its form alone does not force that antecedent. Ān mann does not say whether the man belongs to the original pair or their companions.

> Twēgen męnn bǣron męte. Hiera gefēran sǣton on ðǣm hofe. Đā męnn gēafon ðǣm gefērum ðone męte, and hīe ǣton. Ān mann ne ǣt. Hē geaf his męte ðǣm fuglum. Đā fuglas ǣton and flugon. Se mann sæt on ðǣm strande and geseah ðā fiscas. Đā fiscas swummon on ðǣm wætere.

Connected reading — T1–T4

T1.
In the new account, what did one man do with his food, and what did its recipients do next?

T2.
In ðǣm gefērum ðone męte, identify the recipient and the thing given, and explain their cases. What subject controls gēafon?

T3.
Retell the last two sentences of the new account in the present indicative. Keep the subjects, objects and location phrases.

T4.
Translate the complete new account.

11. Source reading: The first day revisited

This is the same complete first-day passage read in Unit 1, now revisited with the strong finite forms learned in this unit. The original text and assignment are unchanged. Use all the local help below for the constructions that remain supplied. Cook prints the passage in **A First Book in Old English**, Reader I, pp.123–124 (one-based PDF pp.139–140).

> On anginne gescēop God heofonan and eorðan. Sēo eorðe sōðlice wæs īdel and ǣmtig; and ðīestru wǣron ofer ðǣre nēowolnesse brādnesse; and Godes gāst wæs geferęd ofer wæteru. God cwæð ðā, "Geweorðe lēoht"; and lēoht wearð geworht. God geseah ðā ðæt hit gōd wæs; and hē gedǣlde ðæt lēoht fram ðǣm ðīestrum. And hēt ðæt lēoht Dæg, and ðā ðīestru Niht. Ðā wæs geworden ǣfen and morgen ān dæg.

Local help for the first day

Each explanation applies to the actual printed phrase and remains available during R1–R4. Learned indicative morphology does not make these other constructions independent production targets.

On anginne

On anginne: in the beginning.

This is temporal on with a dative. The whole time phrase is supplied; the independent on-construction already practised states location.

heofonan

heofonan: heaven/the sky, accusative singular of weak feminine heofone.

Heofone is a weak feminine noun, and this exact heofonan is accusative singular. It is distinct from the learned masculine heofon and its plural heofonas. No further forms of this feminine noun are required here.

sōðlice

sōðlice: now; for its part.

This connective use differs from the earlier ordinary meaning "truly." Cook's note gives Latin autem. Keep the contextual meaning supplied here.

ofer ðǣre nēowolnesse brādnesse;

ofer ðǣre nēowolnesse brādnesse: over the surface of the deep.

Ofer governs dative brādnesse. The preceding ðære nēowolnesse is feminine genitive singular, dependent on brādnesse. Learn the analysis of this exact phrase without extending it to a complete rule for ofer.

wæs geƿered ofer wæteru.

wæs geƿered ofer wæteru: was borne/carried (moved) over the waters.

Wæs is finite; geƿered is the supplied participle in a passive expression. Here ofer has accusative plural wæteru. Both the passive and this local prepositional construction remain supplied.

ðā / Ðā

ðā / Ðā: then.

These occurrences are temporal adverbs. They are distinct from the identically spelled plural article or demonstrative.

“Geweorðe lēoht”;

Geweorðe lēoht: Let light come to be.

Geweorðe is a third-singular present subjunctive used as an optative, expressing a wish or command. The whole expression is supplied; it is outside the indicative tables.

wearð geworht.

wearð geworht: was made; came into being.

Wearð is the finite preterite. The ordinary meaning of weorðan, “become,” was learned earlier; here wearð serves with the supplied participle geworht in a passive expression. That auxiliary use remains supplied.

geseah ðā ðæt hit gōd wæs;

God geseah … ðæt hit gōd wæs: God saw … that it was good.

Geseah is now a learned indicative form. The conjunction ðæt introduces the supplied content clause; its final wæs belongs inside that clause. Hit refers to neuter lēoht. This ðæt means “that,” not “the.”

gedælde ðæt lēoht fram ðǣm ðīestrum.

gedælde ðæt lēoht fram ðǣm ðīestrum: separated the light from the darkness.

Gedælde is the supplied weak third-singular preterite of gedælan, “divide; separate.” The separating fram + dative construction is already familiar; this additional verb form remains supplied.

hēt ðæt lēoht Dæg, and ðā ðīestru Niht.

He called the light Day and the darkness Night.

The object and the name given to it are both accusative: lēoht/Dæg and ðīestru/Niht. The continuing subject is God; the second naming clause also leaves the verb understood. The finite hēt is learned, while this two-accusative naming construction remains supplied.

Ðā wæs geworden æfen and morgen ān dæg.

Then evening and morning had come to be—one day.

Wæs geworden is a supplied resultative/perfect expression. It describes what has come to be, rather than the passive making in wearð geworht. Preserve ān dæg as "one day." The formula is given whole; no unique subject/predicate division or new agreement rule is required.

First-day revisit — R1–R4

R1.
In the first-day text, identify the lemma, strong class, tense, person and number of gescēop, cwæð, geseah and hēt. Use the clauses to identify the subject of hēt.

Supplied citation for R2: weorðan, "become." The headword is printed for identification; no infinitival construction or unaided citation recall is required.

R2.
Use the first-day notes to distinguish the ordinary meaning of weorðan from its use in wearð geworht. Which word is finite in that supplied phrase?

R3.
The first-day text has heofonan; Cook I.5.1 says the heavens. Using the source note, explain the difference in noun, gender and number.

R4.
Translate the complete first-day passage, using the printed local help where needed.

12. Source reading: The second day

Continue with the complete second-day paragraph, Cook's Reader I, p.124, editorial prose lines 4–10 (one-based PDF p.140). The edition prints marginal line anchors at 5 and 10; the intervening line count is editorial. The new finite knowledge helps with the narrative, while the wishes, relative clauses and closing expressions retain local help.

> God cwæð ðā ęft, “Geweorðe nū fæstnes tōmiddes ðǣm wæterum, and tōtwǣme ðā wæteru fram ðǣm wæterum.” And God geworhte ðā fæstnesse, and tōtwǣmde ðā wæteru ðe wǣron under ðǣre fæstnesse fram ðǣm ðe wǣron bufan ðǣre fæstnesse; hit wæs ðā swā gedōn. And God hēt ðā fæstnesse Heofonan. And wæs ðā geworden æfen and morgen ōðer dæg.

Local help for the second day

The following six groups of help remain available during R5–R8. They explain the actual forms and their relations without requiring independent production of the supplied constructions.

ðā, ęft, nū, swā

ðā: then; ęft: again/also; nū: now; swā: so/thus.

These exact adverbial uses are supplied. Cook glosses ęft with Latin quoque, “also.” Preserve the printed ę.

“Geweorðe nū fæstnes tōmiddes ðǣm wæterum, and tōtwǣme ðā wæteru fram ðǣm wæterum.”

Let a firmament come to be in the midst of the waters, and let it separate the waters from the waters.

Geweorðe and tōtwǣme are coordinated third-singular present optatives; fæstnes is the subject of both. Tōmiddes has dative ðǣm wæterum. Tōtwǣme, “let it separate,” has accusative ðā wæteru and fram + dative. The whole wish and its new preposition remain supplied.

tōtwǣmde ðā wæteru ðe wǣron under ðǣre fæstnesse fram ðǣm ðe wǣron bufan ðǣre fæstnesse;

and separated the waters which were under the firmament from those which were above the firmament.

Tōtwǣmde is the supplied third-singular weak preterite, “separated.” In each relative clause, ðe is the subject of wǣron. The first refers to the waters below the firmament. After fram, dative ðǣm means “those (waters)”; its following relative describes the waters above. Under and bufan both govern dative ðǣre fæstnesse here. These subject-relative clauses and the omitted noun after “those” remain supplied.

hit wæs ðā swā gedōn.

hit wæs ðā swā gedōn: it was then done/made so.

Wæs is finite; gedōn is the supplied past participle of gedōn, "do; make." The whole passive/resultative expression describes the fulfillment of the preceding action.

God hēt ðā fæstnesse Heofonan.

God called the firmament Heaven.

Fæstnesse is the accusative singular object; Heofonan is the accusative singular name, from weak feminine heofone. The hēt form is learned, while this naming construction and feminine noun form remain supplied.

And wæs ðā geworden æfen and morgen ōðer dæg.

And evening and morning had come to be—a second day.

The resultative closing formula remains supplied. Here ōðer means "second" and is masculine nominative singular, agreeing with dæg. Contrast the first-day formula's literal "one day."

Second day — R5–R8

R5.
In the second-day text, distinguish cwæð and hēt from geworhte and the supplied tōtwǣmde. Identify strong and weak preterites, and identify their common subject.

R6.
Using the second-day local help, explain which waters are separated from which. What does ðǣm refer to in fram ðǣm ðe wǣron bufan ðǣre fæstnesse?

R7.
What does God call the firmament in the second-day account? Explain why ōðer agrees with dæg in the closing formula, while keeping the formula itself supplied.

R8.
Translate the complete second-day passage, using the printed local help where needed.

13. Cumulative review

These three exercises are new teaching material. The printed citations in X2 remain supplied; compare the finite systems without adding nonfinite constructions.

X1.

Compare hē geaf and hē sealde. Give the corresponding preterite clauses with ðū, and explain why the endings differ.

Supplied citations for X2: lufian and (ge)lufod. The parentheses in (ge)lufod preserve the earlier source citation notation; they do not introduce a rule for prefixes, perfect or passive syntax.

X2.

The printed entries give swęrian, swōr, swōron, sworen and lufian, lufode, (ge)lufod. Explain why -ian alone does not identify a weak verb. Give the present first-person singular of each.

X3.

Within the taught indicative systems, compare gē sēoð and hē sīeð. Identify each verb, class, tense, person and number. These are form-identification examples; add no complement.

14. Sources and original reading notes

The core strong-verb systems follow Cook, **A First Book in Old English**, §§105–110, printed pp.63–67, with the earlier-class additions from §§101–104. Wright's **Old English Grammar** and the checked dictionary entries corroborate the stated alternatives and lexical uses. Complete finite tables apply the ordinary endings to the checked selected stems; they do not claim a separate surviving quotation for every cell.

The supplied participle **weaxen** is a rule-derived expansion of Cook's and Wright's stated Class VII model. It is not a whole-form attestation in the checked rows. Its status remains citation support only.

The lexical constructions use Cook's case rules and independently checked dictionary evidence for the ordinary verbs. The eight examples and the connected account are new compositions. Their food, companion, bird and fish references are ordinary applications of the stated uses. Diagnostic form practice supplies no additional complement syntax.

The source readings preserve Cook's Old English spelling, quantity and punctuation. Line breaks are joined and note cues are moved to this section. The first-day passage is an explicit revisit of the Unit 1 text; the second-day paragraph is the new continuation. All relevant original notes follow. References such as "53. 3." point to Cook's own grammar or dictionary, not to sections of this unit. The local help above supplies what is needed here.

Cook's notes to the first day

P.123, note 1. See gescieppan, and 18.

P.123, note 2. The order is probably determined by the Latin: creavit Deus.

P.123, note 3. 53. 3.

P.123, note 4. See se.

P.123, note 5. Lat. autem.

P.123, note 6. See wesan.

P.123, note 7. Plural, like Lat. tenebrae.

P.123, note 8. Governs brādnesse.

P.123, note 9. Genitive, dependent on brādnesse (153. i).

P.123, note 10. See 166.

P.123, note 11. wæs geƿered = Lat. ferebatur. See geƿerian.

P.123, note 12. See wæter, and 47. 1, 6.

P.123, note 13. See cweðan.

P.123, note 14. See geweorðan, and 193. a.

P.123, note 15. See weorðan.

P.123, note 16. Wearð geworht = facta est. See gewyrcean.

P.123, note 17. See geseon.

P.123, note 18. See hē.

P.124, note 1. See wesan.
P.124, note 2. See gedǣlan.
P.124, note 3. See se.
P.124, note 4. See p.123, note 7.
P.124, note 5. See hātan, and 189, note.
P.124, note 6. Wæs geworden = factum est. See geweorðan.
P.124, note 7. Lat. dies unus.

Cook's notes to the second day

P.124, note 8. See cweðan.
P.124, note 9. Lat. quoque.
P.124, note 10. See geweorðan, and 193. a.
P.124, note 11. See wæter, and 47. 1, 6.
P.124, note 12. See tōtwǣman.
P.124, note 13. See 87. d.
P.124, note 14. Past part. of gedōn.
P.124, note 15. See 173.
P.124, note 16. Lat. secundus.